

it's the Calendar app. In both cases, you can view and interact with multiple accounts worth of data, all in one place. That is not how email works. In fact, Windows Phone handles email in a way that is completely the opposite of how it handles contacts and calendars. More important, maybe, the way Windows Phone handles email is also in opposition to the Windows Phone mantra of integrated experiences. Put more simply, there is no such thing as a unified inbox on Windows Phone, a feature that is common to other smart phones such as the iPhone or those based on Google Android. Instead, Windows Phone creates a different Mail application for each configured email account.

That may sound counterproductive. And certainly, there is room for debate on this one. But there's no debating that Windows Phone does work this way. It's not perfect. But depending on your situation, it could make a big difference. Of course, you may actually want to access all of your email accounts separately. If that's the case, just use Windows Phone as Microsoft intended. For each email account you create, Windows Phone will create a new email application in the All Programs list. And you are free, of course, to pin as many of them as you'd like to the Windows Phone Start screen too.

Using mail

If you enjoy the rich graphical user interfaces in hubs such as Pictures or Music + Video, the Windows Phone Mail application might come as a bit of a shock. By default, it presents a stark interface, with black text on a bright white background that Microsoft claims is ideal for the primary email activity of reading. Calendar, though also text-based, uses white text on a black background by default.

Try to get over your initial impression of this application because it's actually a highly efficient and capable email solution. If you've spent any time at all with mobile email solutions on other platforms, you'll understand why immediately. The key to this success is Windows Phone's pivot-based, single screen application user interface, which is used to nice effect in



You can see flagged and urgent email as well